Rippling Removal for macOS

rippling_removal_macos.sh · v2.0.3 · Iru, Inc.

Removes leftover Rippling components from Mac devices after they have migrated to Iru. A verbose rewrite of Iru's 2021 rippling_removal.sh — same job, same observable behavior, with the gaps from the original closed.

Ships safe by default. As delivered, the script runs in dry-run mode — it scans, reports, and changes nothing. You must edit one line to make it act.

Quick start

STEP	WHAT TO DO
1. Dry run	Push the script as-is from the Iru console (Custom Script library item, runs as root) to one test Mac.
2. Read the verdict	Open the script output in the Iru console and read the SUMMARY block at the bottom.
3. Go live	If the FOUND lines look right, change `DRY_RUN="true"` → `"false"` and push again.
4. Log out / restart	If a Rippling menu-bar icon is still visible, log out or restart to clear it — the process was already stopped.
5. Roll out	Push live mode to the remaining devices. Safe to re-run anywhere.

The two modes

One variable controls everything (top of the script, under **Editable defaults**):

```
DRY_RUN="true"    # DRY RUN (default) — scan and report only. Changes NOTHING.
DRY_RUN="false"   # LIVE — same scan, actually removes what it finds.
```

There are no other modes. Dry run and live produce identical scans, so a dry-run report is an exact preview of what live mode will do.

What it does — three phases

Phase 1 · Assessment (read-only, runs in both modes)

Answers: "did the migration actually complete on this device?"

- Is the Iru agent present? (checks for `/usr/local/bin/kandji`)
- Any Rippling MDM enrollment remnants? (inspected only — never modified)
- Is the Rippling app still on disk? (`Rippling.app`, `RipplingMDM.app`, `/opt/rippling`, `/usr/local/rippling`)

- Are any Rippling processes running? (the reason a menu-bar icon can persist after files are gone)

Phase 2 · Sweep (honors the mode switch)

In this order — the order is deliberate, see Safety below:

1. **Per-user LaunchAgents** — unloaded from the signed-in user's session, then removed
2. **System LaunchDaemons** — booted out, then removed
3. **Processes** — any running Rippling process (this script excludes itself)
4. **Files & folders** — `/opt/rippling`, `/usr/local/rippling`, the app bundles, and every user's Application Support folders matching Rippling (e.g., `Rippling`, `rippling-tray`)
5. **Package receipts** — every pkgutil receipt matching Rippling
6. **Munki** — launch items, Managed Software Center, managed-install files, and receipts, where deployed
7. **Chef** — launch items, `chef-workstation` / `inspec`, and receipts, where deployed
8. **Login-window text** — reset only if Rippling had set one

Phase 3 · Summary

Counts (found / removed / failed) plus a one-line RESULT verdict. This is the block to read in the Iru console — read the output bottom-up.

Reading the RESULT line

VERDICT	MEANING	YOUR MOVE
CLEAN	Migration already removed everything.	Nothing to do.
DRY RUN complete	Report only; FOUND lines = what live mode would remove.	Review, then flip `DRY_RUN`.
CLEANED	Live run removed everything it found.	Log out / restart if a menu-bar icon lingers.
PARTIAL	Some items couldn't be removed.	Restart, then re-run the script.

Output goes to two places: the Iru console (standard output) and the macOS unified log (tagged `[rippling_removal]`, viewable with `log show` or Console.app). The script does not write its own log file.

Exit codes: `0` = clean, dry run complete, or cleaned · `1` = live run with failed removals.

Optional flag (default: off)

FLAG	DEFAULT	WHAT ENABLING IT DOES	BEFORE YOU ENABLE IT
`REMOVE_RIPPLING_ADMIN`	`"false"`	Deletes the RipplingAdmin local admin account + its home directory.	Confirm another local admin exists on the device. On some fleets it's the only

FLAG	DEFAULT	WHAT ENABLING IT DOES	BEFORE YOU ENABLE IT
			local admin. Left off, the script just logs a warning.

The account name is set by `USER_TO_REMOVE="RipplingAdmin"` — change it only if your Rippling tenant used a different name. The flag works the same in either mode and can be handled later as a follow-up; nothing forces the decision on day one.

> **Note on Munki and Chef.** Unlike the Windows script's Chocolatey flag, Munki and Chef removal on macOS is part of the standard sweep, not a separate toggle — they are removed when present because they were part of Rippling's delivery stack. If your environment uses Munki or Chef independently of Rippling, scope those sections out before running live.

Safety design

- **Dry-run by default** — first contact with any machine is an audit, not an action.
- **Enrollment is inspected, never touched.** Rippling's MDM configuration profiles are read with `profiles list` for reporting only; the script never removes a profile. Migration and re-enrollment own that.
- **Relaunch-safe ordering.** Launch agents and daemons are unloaded before their processes are killed and their files deleted, so launchd can't relaunch a component mid-cleanup.
- **Every removal is verified.** After deleting a path, the script re-checks that it's gone and reports FAILED if it isn't, so the summary reflects reality.
- **Idempotent.** Re-running in any mode, on any device state, is safe — devices converge to clean.
- **Out of scope, on purpose:** MDM enrollment profiles (above) and the local admin account (unless you enable the flag).

FAQ

The dry run found a bunch of items — is that bad? It means the migration's app-removal step didn't fully complete on that device (the MDM handoff can still be fine). That's exactly what this script is for. Flip to live mode.

The Rippling menu-bar icon is still there right after a live run — did it fail? No. If the summary says CLEANED and shows a "Process killed" line, the process was stopped and its files removed; the icon you're seeing is the last frame of a stopped process. It clears at the next logout or restart, and nothing remains on the device to bring it back. (The summary's menu-bar note only appears on runs where a process was actually killed.)

Can I run it twice? Yes — any mode, any order, any number of times.

Why do I see "kandji" in the agent detection? Deliberate, not a branding miss: the agent binary path is unchanged post-rebrand, so the agent check looks for `/usr/local/bin/kandji`. Explained in a comment at that line.

Version history

- **2.0.3** — Phase 1 process check no longer self-matches the script itself (a field live run showed a false "processes RUNNING" warning); process kill sweep hardened the same way; the menu-bar note in the summary now prints only when a process was actually killed that run.
- **2.0.2** — Field dry run (2026-07-14) revealed the Rippling install root at `/usr/local/rippling` and per-user data at `~/Library/Application Support/rippling-tray`; both added to the assessment and sweep. Per-user Application Support matching is now discovery-based rather than exact-name.
- **2.0.1** — Chef launch-item removal now verifies deletion; Chef launch-item matching corrected to Chef's actual namespaces (`com.getchef` / `com.chef`); login-window reset read-back verified.
- **2.0.0** — Verbose rewrite of the 2021 script: dry-run mode, phased structure, verified removals, verdicts, exit codes.